Day 109 — TNPSC Group 2A Study Material

Part A – General Studies: Current Affairs in Geography of India (10): The National River Linking Project's Status (2026)

READING MATERIAL

Covers India's National River Linking Project (NRLP) — its full scope, 2026 implementation status, and emerging environmental research concerns.

Q: What is the full scope of India's National River Linking Project (NRLP)?

A: 30 planned river links, intended to transfer an estimated 200 billion cubic metres of water around the country annually, at an estimated cost of about $168 billion.

Q: Which specific link project (already covered as a standalone topic) is the FIRST to enter implementation under the NRLP framework?

A: The Ken-Betwa Link Project — its foundation stone was laid in December 2024, diverting surplus water from the Ken river to the Betwa river.

Q: What is the NRLP's 2026 documentation/planning status across all 30 projects?

A: Pre-Feasibility Reports (PFRs): completed for ALL 30 projects. Feasibility Reports (FRs): completed for 26 projects. Detailed Project Reports (DPRs): completed for 11 projects.

Q: What environmental concerns did 2026 research raise about river interlinking?

A: That the interlinking routes could act as ecological corridors enabling biotic exchange between previously-isolated river basins — potentially accelerating biological invasions, disrupting migratory routes, altering hydrological regimes, and undermining ecosystem resilience.

Q: What principle governs the implementation of interlinking-of-rivers (ILR) projects across states?

A: CONSENSUS — implementation depends on agreement among the concerned states, since river-linking often involves inter-state water-sharing.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. India's National River Linking Project (NRLP) plans how many river links in total?

A. 20

B. 25

C. 30 ✓

D. 35

Explanation: 30 links. [medium, web-research]

2. The NRLP's estimated total cost is approximately:

A. $68 billion

B. $118 billion

C. $168 billion ✓

D. $218 billion

Explanation: $168 billion. [hard, web-research]

3. Which link project was the first to enter implementation under the NRLP?

A. Ken-Betwa Link Project ✓

B. Godavari-Cauvery Link

C. Par-Tapi-Narmada Link

D. Damanganga-Pinjal Link

Explanation: Ken-Betwa Link Project. [medium, web-research]

4. As of 2026, Pre-Feasibility Reports (PFRs) are complete for how many of the NRLP's 30 projects?

A. 11

B. 20

C. 26

D. All 30 ✓

Explanation: All 30 projects. [hard, web-research]

5. Implementation of interlinking-of-rivers projects depends primarily on:

   A. Central government's unilateral decision

   B. Consensus among concerned states ✓

   C. Supreme Court approval only

   D. UN environmental clearance

   Explanation: Consensus among concerned states. [medium, web-research]

Part B – Aptitude & Mental Ability: Dice

READING MATERIAL

Dice is 1 of 6 named Reasoning skills. Real exam evidence (explicitly tagged by source year, 2013-2025) shows two distinct shapes: opposite-face deduction from multiple cube views, and dice-throw probability.

Q: Foundational rule: On a standard die, what do opposite faces always sum to, and why does this matter for solving these puzzles?

A: Opposite faces always sum to 7 (1-6, 2-5, 3-4) on a STANDARD die — but TNPSC dice puzzles often use lettered or non-standard-numbered faces specifically to stop you from relying on this shortcut, forcing you to actually deduce relationships from the given views instead.

Q: Method — deducing an opposite face from adjacency information: If face 2 is adjacent to faces 3, 5, and 6, what must be true about face 1's relationship to face 4?

A: Since 2 is adjacent to 3, 5, and 6, those three faces can't be opposite 2 — leaving only 1 or 4 as 2's possible opposite. With four faces (3,5,6, and whichever of 1/4 is also adjacent) surrounding face 2, the remaining face must be its opposite, and separately, on a standard 6-face die, this kind of constraint typically forces 1 and 4 to be adjacent to each other (since they're not the 2-pair) — real exam answer: '1 is necessarily adjacent to 4.'

Q: Method — three views of a cube → find the opposite face: Three pictures of the same cube show different combinations of visible letters/numbers. How do you find what's opposite a given face?

A: A face that appears on multiple different views, each time paired with DIFFERENT other visible faces, helps you eliminate possibilities — any face that has been seen adjacent to your target face (in ANY view) cannot be its opposite. Whatever face is never seen adjacent to it across all views is the opposite face.

Q: Method — probability of a sum from two dice: What is the probability of getting a prime-number sum when throwing two dice?

A: Possible sums range 2-12 (36 total equally likely outcomes from 6×6). Prime sums possible: 2,3,5,7,11. Count outcomes for each: sum=2(1 way),3(2),5(4),7(6),11(2) = 15 outcomes. Probability = 15/36.

Q: Method — basic single-die probability: What is the probability of throwing a number greater than 4 on a single die?

A: Numbers greater than 4 on a standard die: 5 and 6 — that's 2 out of 6 outcomes. Probability = 2/6 = 1/3.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. On a standard die, the numbers on opposite faces always sum to:

A. 6

B. 7 ✓

C. 8

D. 9

Explanation: 7 (1-6, 2-5, 3-4). [easy, authored]

2. What is the probability of getting a sum of 7 when two dice are thrown?

A. 1/12

B. 1/9

C. 1/6 ✓

D. 1/4

Explanation: 6 ways to make 7 out of 36 total outcomes: 6/36=1/6. [medium, authored]

3. What is the probability of throwing an odd number on a single die?

A. 1/6

B. 1/3

C. 1/2 ✓

D. 2/3

Explanation: Odd numbers (1,3,5) = 3 of 6 outcomes = 1/2. [easy, authored]

4. If face 1 is adjacent to faces 2, 3, 4, and 5 on a die, which face must be opposite face 1?

A. 2

B. 3

C. 4

D. 6 ✓

Explanation: Since 2,3,4,5 are all adjacent to 1, the only remaining face (6) must be opposite it. [medium, authored]

5. What is the probability of getting a sum greater than 10 when two dice are thrown?

A. 1/36

B. 1/12 ✓

C. 1/9

D. 1/6

Explanation: Sums >10 means 11 (2 ways) or 12 (1 way) = 3 outcomes out of 36 = 1/12. [medium, authored]

Part C – General English: Poem: "The Grumble Family" — L.M. Montgomery

READING MATERIAL

A humorous, cautionary poem about a family that complains about absolutely everything, living on 'Complaining Street'. Real coaching-site evidence tests the poem's setting, irony, and a couple of figures of speech.

Q: Who wrote "The Grumble Family", and what is its central theme?

A: L.M. Montgomery. Central theme: the danger of constant complaining — the poem warns against habitual negativity and urges readers to adopt a positive attitude instead.

Q: Where does the Grumble family live?

A: On 'Complaining Street', in the city of 'Never-Are-Satisfied', beside the 'River of Discontent' — all symbolically named to match the family's perpetually negative outlook.

Q: What is ironic about the Grumble family's behaviour?

A: They complain even when things are perfect — rain or sun, summer or winter, high or humble status, nothing satisfies them, which is the central irony: their unhappiness isn't caused by genuinely bad circumstances, but by their own habit of complaining regardless of circumstances.

Q: Identify the figure of speech: "The River of Discontent beside."

A: Imagery — a vivid descriptive image (a symbolic river) representing the family's emotional state.

Q: Identify the figure of speech: "Growl at the rain and growl at the sun."

A: Alliteration — repeated initial sounds, here also reflected in similar examples like 'They'd growl that they'd nothing to grumble about'.

Q: What does the poet ultimately want readers to do, per the poem's message?

A: Stop complaining and develop a positive attitude — to 'walk with a smile and a song' rather than grumble regardless of circumstances.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. "The Grumble Family" was written by:

A. Rudyard Kipling

B. L.M. Montgomery ✓

C. Jane Taylor

D. R.L. Stevenson

Explanation: L.M. Montgomery. [easy, web-research]

2. The main theme of the poem is:

A. City life

B. The danger of complaining ✓

C. Weather conditions

D. Family reunion

Explanation: The danger of complaining. [easy, web-research]

3. What is the name of the street the Grumble family lives on?

A. Lonely Street

B. Happy Lane

C. Complaining Street ✓

D. River Road

Explanation: Complaining Street. [easy, web-research]

4. What is ironic about the Grumble family's behaviour?

A. They never complain

B. They are praised for kindness

C. They complain even when things are perfect ✓

D. They're always joyful

Explanation: They complain regardless of how good circumstances actually are. [medium, web-research]

5. "The River of Discontent beside" is an example of which device?

   A. Simile

   B. Metaphor

   C. Alliteration

   D. Imagery ✓

   Explanation: Imagery. [medium, web-research]

6. "Growl at the rain and growl at the sun" uses which figure of speech?

   A. Metaphor

   B. Personification

   C. Hyperbole

   D. Alliteration ✓

   Explanation: Alliteration. [medium, web-research]